

Venture Plus × Specialist Services

Corporate Travel Management Platform — Scope & Workflow Document

Client: Specialist Services

Travel execution partner: Venture Plus

Final approver: Chris Ridley (President)

Program owner: HR / Melissa Payumo (governance and oversight)

1. Purpose

This document defines what the corporate travel platform covers, how travel moves through the system, what is required, which scenarios it must handle, what stays outside the platform, and what remains undecided.

Central principle: The platform manages the workflow, visibility, and governance. A licensed travel agency — operated through Venture Plus's travel desk — executes actual flight and hotel bookings in their own systems.

2. What Is in the System

The platform is a travel management and workflow layer. It is not a booking engine.

2.1 Core capabilities

Area	What the system does
Travel requests	Employees submit individual travel forms with full trip details
Approvals	Requests route through the approval hierarchy and require Chris's final sign-off before any booking activity
Travel desk queue	Venture Plus receives approved requests automatically

Area	What the system does
Structured options	Flights, hotels, and cars are presented as clear, comparable cards — not email screenshots
Traveler profiles	Passport, seat, meal, loyalty numbers, and class eligibility are stored once and applied on every trip
Policy enforcement	Regional cost bands are checked; over-band bookings are flagged and escalated
Visa management	Visa requirement blocks all booking until documents are complete and visa is approved
Selection & confirmation	Employee or desk selects an option; system records confirmation and generates itinerary
Documents	Trip-named tickets and vouchers (e.g. Sarah Ahmed – Amsterdam – Sep 2026 – KLM Ticket)
Notifications	Traveler, HR, and desk are notified at key stages; HR is copied without needing to coordinate manually
Governance views	HR monitors compliance, visa status, band breaches, and profile accuracy
Management reporting	Spend by traveler, destination, and region; over-band incident tracking
Traveler safety tracker	Live view of who is outside the UAE, where they are, and when they return
Audit trail	Full record of request, approval, selection, booking, and exceptions

2.2 User roles

Role	Primary use of the system
Employee	Submit requests, upload visa documents, review options, view itinerary
Manager	Acknowledge or approve at department level (if required)

Role	Primary use of the system
Chris (President)	Final approval; reconfirm over-band exceptions
Venture Plus travel desk	Receive approved requests, source options, publish to portal, confirm bookings
HR (Melissa)	Governance — visa oversight, band breaches, profile management, safety tracking
Management	Spend visibility and traveler location for duty-of-care

2.3 Travel request form fields

Each request is individual per traveler — no combined group forms.

Field	Description
Traveler name	Person traveling
Department	Employee's department
Department head	Reporting manager
Purpose of travel	Reason for the trip
Project number / client name	For cost allocation and re-invoicing
Origin and destination	Travel route
Departure date + preferred timing	e.g. late afternoon / early evening
Return date + preferred timing	e.g. afternoon for full client day
Hotel requirement	Yes / No
Preferred hotel location	Area or property preference
Check-in / check-out dates	Hotel dates
Car / transport requirement	Yes / No, with pickup/return details
Onward / additional travel	Multi-leg or extended itinerary
Visa declaration	Whether visa is required

Field	Description
Urgent flag	Time-sensitive travel marker
GL code	Optional — finance ownership still TBD

2.4 Traveler profile fields

Maintained once per person, used on every booking:

Field	Purpose
Passport number, issue date, expiry	Pre-loaded for visa and ticketing
Nationality and date of birth	Visa and airline compliance
Loyalty / frequent-flyer numbers	Applied automatically to every booking
Travel class eligibility	Economy / Premium Economy / Business
Seat preference	Aisle / Window
Meal preference	Veg / Non-veg / Vegan etc.
Preferred airlines / hotels	Optional recurring preferences

Travel class rules:

Traveler tier	Class
Chris (President)	Business
VP level + Kyle + Melissa	Premium Economy (where available)
All other employees	Economy

2.5 Cost bands

Defined thresholds govern auto-processing. Bookings within band proceed. Bookings exceeding band are paused until Chris reconfirms.

Flight ticket bands (AED):

Region	Threshold
GCC	3,000
Europe	5,000
Asia	3,500
Rest of World	Case-by-case

Hotel nightly bands (AED):

Region	Threshold
GCC	600
Europe	900
Asia	450
Rest of World	Case-by-case

2.6 Hard business rules enforced in the system

Rule	Description
No pre-approval booking	Nothing is booked until Chris approves
Visa hard gate	If visa is required: no ticket and no booking work until visa is fully secured
One form per traveler	Each person's movement is independently traceable
Approved form = source of truth	Travel desk does not deviate from approved instructions
Over-band pause	Fares or hotels exceeding regional threshold require Chris reconfirmation with documented rationale
Car on form only	Car rentals must be declared on the travel request form at submission

3. Workflow

3.1 Master end-to-end flow

Workflow diagram

3.2 Who does what — portal, desk, and agency

Workflow diagram

3.3 Responsibility matrix

Activity	Portal	Travel desk	Agency
Submit travel request	✓		
Approve travel	✓		
Maintain traveler profile	✓		
Enforce cost bands and visa gate	✓		
Search real inventory		✓	✓
Present structured options	✓	✓	
Advise on best overall option		✓	
Select preferred option	✓	✓	
Issue ticket / hotel voucher		✓	✓
Pay airline / hotel			✓
Apply seat, meal, loyalty preferences	✓	✓	✓
Show itinerary to traveler	✓		
Spend dashboard / safety tracker	✓		
Audit trail	✓		

3.4 Three-layer architecture

3.5 How booking confirmation works

In the platform: Employee or desk selects an option. System checks policy (bands, visa, class). Status moves to confirmed. Itinerary and trip-named documents are generated. Dashboards update.

Outside the platform: Venture Plus desk instructs the agency to book the selected flight, hotel, or car in the agency's system. Agency issues the real ticket or voucher and pays the supplier on credit terms. Desk uploads the real documents back to the portal.

Integration path:

Phase	How it works
v1 — Manual	Desk searches agency system, enters options into portal, books after selection, uploads confirmation
v2 — API (optional)	Portal calls agency API for search and booking; confirmation syncs automatically

4. Requirements

4.1 Functional requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	Individual travel request form per traveler	Must have
FR-02	Capture all form fields listed in Section 2.3	Must have
FR-03	Approval workflow ending with Chris — no booking before approval	Must have
FR-04	Auto-notify Venture Plus desk and HR on approval	Must have
FR-05	Traveler profile with passport, preferences, loyalty, class eligibility	Must have

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-06	Structured flight / hotel / car option presentation	Must have
FR-07	Options matched to timing preferences and trip requirements	Must have
FR-08	Consultant recommendation on best overall option (not price alone)	Must have
FR-09	Auto-apply seat, meal, and loyalty from profile on booking	Must have
FR-10	Regional cost band check on flights and hotels	Must have
FR-11	Over-band flag with Chris reconfirmation and documented rationale	Must have
FR-12	Visa hard gate — block all booking until visa approved	Must have
FR-13	Travel Hub visa checklist and document upload tracking	Must have
FR-14	HR NOC and salary certificate tracking for visa cases	Must have
FR-15	Trip-named document delivery	Must have
FR-16	Hotel payment / voucher status visible before travel	Must have
FR-17	Complete itinerary view for traveler	Must have
FR-18	HR governance view (not operational relay)	Must have
FR-19	Spend dashboard by traveler, destination, region, band	Must have

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-20	Traveler safety tracker — who is outside UAE, where, return date	Must have
FR-21	Audit trail for every trip	Must have
FR-22	Travel class rules applied from profile	Must have
FR-23	Car rental declared on form and booked as part of package	Must have
FR-24	Urgent travel flag at submission	Should have
FR-25	Multi-destination / multi-leg on single form	Should have
FR-26	Notification to travel@specserve.com	Should have
FR-27	Corporate rate indicator on hotel / airline options	Should have
FR-28	GL code field on request form	Could have — ownership TBD

4.2 Non-functional requirements

ID	Requirement
NF-01	Web-based platform accessible on desktop and mobile browser
NF-02	Role-based access per persona (employee, Chris, desk, HR, management)
NF-03	Professional, corporate-grade user interface
NF-04	Audit log retained for compliance
NF-05	Traveler profile data stored securely

4.3 Visa workflow requirements

When visa is declared on the travel request:

Step	Owner	Action
1	Traveler	Declares visa requirement at form submission
2	Traveler	Downloads destination checklist from Travel Hub; gathers documents
3	Traveler	Submits visa form, passport copy, ID photo, invitation letter (if required)
4	HR	Issues NOC and salary certificate
5	Venture Plus desk	Verifies all documents against visa requirements matrix
6	Venture Plus desk	Submits visa application; advises on processing timeline
7	Venture Plus desk	Marks visa approved in system
8	System	Unlocks booking; desk proceeds with flight and hotel

Hard rule: No ticket issued. No booking worked on. Until visa is fully secured.

4.4 Option presentation requirements

Flight and hotel options must be presented so a decision can be made quickly without reviewing emails or screenshots.

Each flight option must show:

- Airline and flight number
- Direct or connecting (with stop details)
- Departure and arrival times
- Total journey duration
- Price in AED
- Cost band status (within / over)
- Consultant recommendation flag (where applicable)
- Match to requested timing preference

Decision factors beyond price:

- Direct vs connecting
- Departure / arrival timing vs client meeting schedule
- Total travel time and employee productivity
- Hotel cost and location
- Baggage and inclusions
- Whether a cheaper fare excludes benefits or requires an extra hotel night

5. Scenarios

Scenario 1 — Standard travel (no visa)

Situation: Employee travels to Europe for a client visit. No visa required.

Example: Sarah Ahmed — Dubai → Amsterdam — 12–15 Sep 2026 — Project #SS-2026-NL-04

Workflow diagram

Step	Portal	Agency
Sarah submits form with timing and hotel preferences	Request created, pending approval	—
Chris approves	Desk and HR notified	—
Desk loads Sarah's profile (aisle, veg, economy)	Options published in portal	Searches flights and hotels
Sarah selects KLM direct + Crowne Plaza Utrecht	Band check passes (within Europe limits)	Books ticket and hotel
System confirms	Itinerary issued, preferences applied, HR notified	Pays hotel on credit terms

Flight options presented:

Option	Airline	Route	Depart	Price	Band
Recommended	KLM	Direct	16:45	AED 4,200	Within
B	Emirates	Direct	14:20	AED 4,650	Within

Option	Airline	Route	Depart	Price	Band
C	Qatar Airways	1 stop	11:00	AED 3,800	Within

Scenario 2 — Visa-required travel

Situation: Traveler needs a visa. Booking is locked until visa is approved.

Example: Raj Patel — Dubai → Frankfurt — Indian passport

Workflow diagram

Step	Portal	Agency
Raj submits with visa flag	Booking locked — visa pending	—
Chris approves travel request	Lock remains	—
Raj uploads documents; HR provides NOC	Checklist tracked in portal	—
Desk verifies and submits visa	Status updated	Visa application submitted
Visa approved	Booking unlocked	—
Desk presents options and books	Itinerary issued	Ticket and hotel booked

Scenario 3 — Over-band escalation

Situation: Selected fare exceeds regional cost band. Booking pauses until Chris reconfirms.

Example: Kyle Morrison — Dubai → Singapore — only direct option AED 4,100 (Asia band: AED 3,500)

Workflow diagram

Step	Portal	Agency
Kyle selects over-band option	System flags and pauses booking	—

Step	Portal	Agency
HR reviews with justification	Escalation sent to Chris	—
Chris reconfirms with reason	Rationale stored in audit trail	—
Desk proceeds	Booking confirmed	Books in agency system

Scenario 4 — Urgent / last-minute travel

Situation: Time-sensitive trip. Form still required; flagged urgent at submission.

Step	Portal	Agency
Employee flags URGENT	Request moves to top of desk queue	—
Chris expedites approval	Priority notification to desk	—
Desk prioritizes search	Options published quickly	Immediate inventory search
If band cannot be met	Over-band escalation (Scenario 3)	Books best available

Urgency affects queue priority and desk response. It does not bypass approval or policy rules.

Scenario 5 — Executive travel (business class)

Situation: Travel class is applied automatically from the traveler profile.

Example: Chris Ridley — Dubai → London

Step	Portal	Agency
Form submitted	Business class auto-applied from profile	—
Chris approves	Standard flow	—
Desk presents options	Business-class options only; aisle seat noted	Searches business inventory
Booking confirmed	Skywards number applied	Business ticket issued

Scenario 6 — Multi-destination travel

Situation: All legs declared on one form before submission. Processed as a single itinerary.

Example: Dubai → Amsterdam → Frankfurt → Dubai

Step	Portal	Agency
Employee declares all legs	Multi-segment form captured	—
Chris approves entire itinerary	Single approved request	—
Desk processes	Options per leg; single itinerary view	Books all segments as one trip

No back-and-forth to add segments after approval.

Scenario 7 — Client inbound travel to UAE

Situation: Host department arranges travel for a visiting client or partner.

Step	Portal	Agency
Host submits inbound form	Client name, arrival, hotel, car captured	—
Chris approves	Standard flow	—
Desk arranges	UAE hotel band applied; corporate rate if available	Books hotel and airport transfer

Scenario 8 — Group travel (individual forms)

Situation: Multiple people traveling. Each person submits their own form.

Example: Three salespeople traveling to Singapore — separate itineraries

Workflow diagram

Each traveler has an independent form, approval, and booking. If itineraries diverge later, no form becomes invalid.

Scenario 9 — Hotel payment confirmation

Situation: Hotel payment must be confirmed before the traveler arrives at the property.

Status in portal	Meaning
Pending payment	Agency has initiated hotel booking
Voucher issued	Agency has confirmed booking with hotel
Confirmed / Paid	Payment cleared — safe to check in

Prevents the situation where a traveler arrives with a valid voucher but the hotel has not been paid.

Scenario summary

#	Scenario	Visa gate	Band check	Agency books
1	Standard (no visa)	No	Yes	Yes
2	Visa required	Yes — hard lock	Yes	Yes (after visa)
3	Over-band escalation	No	Yes — blocks	Yes (after reconfirm)
4	Urgent / last-minute	Optional	Yes	Yes
5	Executive (business class)	No	Yes	Yes
6	Multi-destination	Optional	Per leg	Yes
7	Client inbound UAE	No	Yes	Yes
8	Group (individual forms)	Optional	Per person	Yes (each)
9	Hotel payment confirmation	No	Yes	Yes

6. What Is Not in the System

The following are explicitly out of scope for the platform. They remain with the travel agency, finance, or other systems.

6.1 Booking and inventory

Item	Who handles it
Real flight / hotel / car inventory search	Travel agency (GDS / agency platform)
Live pricing and seat availability	Travel agency
Ticket issuance	Licensed IATA travel agency
Hotel voucher generation	Travel agency
Payment to airlines, hotels, and suppliers	Travel agency on credit terms
Booking amendments and cancellations	Travel desk + agency
Direct GDS integration (Amadeus, Sabre, etc.)	Not planned — requires IATA licensing and large deposits

6.2 Commercial and rate management

Item	Who handles it
Corporate rate negotiation with airlines	Travel agency / Venture Plus partnership
Corporate hotel rate agreements (Marriott, etc.)	Travel agency
Airline business rewards registration	Travel agency
Hotel loyalty program management	Travel agency
Flight markup / agency fee structure	Commercial agreement between Venture Plus and client

6.3 Finance and operations

Item	Who handles it
Invoice generation and payment to agency	Finance department
Invoice reconciliation (matching invoices to travelers)	Finance department
GL code assignment on travel costs	Finance / HR — ownership TBD

Item	Who handles it
Corporate card management for direct bookings	Finance department
Call-off PO / credit limit management with agency	Finance + Venture Plus

6.4 Other systems

Item	Notes
Centurion approval system integration	Not in initial scope — platform may replace or run alongside
Email auto-extraction / inbox-to-ticket	Future phase
Full visa matrix for all countries and nationalities	Agency maintains matrix; platform shows checklist per destination
Self-service booking by employees (Booking.com / Marriott direct)	Not in scope — credit and governance constraints

6.5 What the platform does not replace

Responsibility	Notes
Travel agency books flights and hotels	Agency still books — platform governs the process around it
Chris approves all travel	Unchanged — Chris retains approval authority
Agency holds IATA deposits and credit with airlines	Unchanged — agency responsibility
Finance pays agency invoices	Unchanged — finance responsibility

7. Summary

What we build	Travel management portal — request, approval, options, profiles, policy, itinerary, dashboards
What the agency does	Real inventory, ticketing, hotel vouchers, supplier payment, corporate rates
What Venture Plus desk does	Operates between portal and agency — advises, publishes options, confirms bookings
What HR does	Governs — does not coordinate every email and booking
What Chris does	Approves all travel; reconfirms over-band exceptions
Core message	One place for the full travel journey. Preferences stored once. Policy enforced. Agency books the travel.

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